

GAME TALK - draft 4

By Lindsey Salatka

Characters:

KATHRYN, a 50+-year-old sporty mom of Sasha

ANGELA, a 50+-year-old mom of Hailey

TIME:

Present day

Setting:

Sideline of High School Soccer game.

***KATHRYN** is sitting on a stadium seat in the front row of the bleachers at her freshman daughter's high school soccer game. Her friend and fellow player mom, **ANGELA**, rushes up, straight from work. She sets up her stadium seat next to Kathryn and sits down.*

***Kathryn** hands **Angela** a pom pom:*

KATHRYN

Five minutes left in the first. We're down by one. It's utter agony.

ANGELA

Ugh, I'm sorry I'm so late! I left the office 90 minutes ago! How's Hailey playing?

KATHRYN

She's, eh, you know...

ANGELA

Riding the bench.

KATHRYN

Pretty much yeah. She's only a freshman, what do you expect? And look! She's in now! See?

Yells

Go Hailey! Show em who's boss! Go Ravens! Let's turn this ship around!

ANGELA

Go Hailey!

KATHRYN

waving at the game in front of them with her Pom Pom

I just love all this. The energy, the excitement! The spirit, the unity! All tied up in a bow of coordinating royal blue moisture wicking polyester. I wish I was out there...

ANGELA

Can their shorts get any smaller though? I can see the crease where butt meets leg on every single one of them. I don't need to see that crease, do you?

KATHRYN

I don't, but what's the better choice? Make them wear something more conservative? That feels very Taliban. I guess I'd rather let them choose what they want to wear even if I hate it and have to train my gaze to stay on their faces.

(Yells to field)

That's your ball, Sasha! *Take your ball!*

ANGELA looks at the field.

ANGELA

Can't there be a balance that exists somewhere between a burka and Girls Gone Wild? I mean, I know this isn't that...Look, I went to Catholic high school in Phoenix. The nuns had wooden rulers to make sure our skirts weren't more than one inch above our knees.

KATHRYN

Squints at field, tense then disappointed

How'd that balance work for you?

ANGELA

Oh my god did you see that pass?

(yells)

Yes, Sasha! Just like that, Girl Boss!

KATHRYN

(yells)

Go go go! Awww.

Shrugs, dropping her pom pom

ANGELA

I don't know, they were just *the rules*. We all had to follow them or spend our afternoons in detention. I already had enough detention from chewing gum and walking on the grass. There was

no point in fighting this particular rule or any of the little rules really; it wasn't a democracy, and those nuns could be mean...

KATHRYN

Pauses, not looking at Angela

But when do the rules become *not* okay? Where is the line between an awkward pleated skirt and the Handmaid's Tale?

(yells to field)

Stay *right where you are*, Sasha! That is *your turf*!

ANGELA

Why are we even talking about this? I didn't fight the rules, and when the nuns walked away we rolled our skirts up to the tops of our thighs. See? The audacity of youth is wasted on the young.

KATHRYN

Laughing

So the world could see your butt crease?

ANGELA

Smiling

Only if *I* could help it.

KATHRYN

Example #7,512 of rules created to stifle us having the opposite effect.

ANGELA

Who even cares about this now? That was 30 years ago!

Neither speaks as they squint at the field
Oh my god, Hailey just flipped that ball to Sasha!

They both stand.

KATHRYN

She did that! She did that!

(yelling to field)

Yes, Hailey! There's no I in team!

(They grab hands)

Penalty? On who?

ANGELA

Come on, ref! Did you forget your glasses?

Angela and Kathryn both hold their readers out toward the ref.

ANGELA AND KATHRYN

Yelling to field

Defense! (clap, clap) Defense! (clap, clap)

ANGELA

Awww.

They cringe and sit again.

Can I confess something?

KATHRYN

But of course. I didn't go to catholic school, but I can still hear your confession.

ANGELA

High school was the last time I was even slightly audacious.

KATHRYN

What do you mean?

ANGELA

This, the sideline, is the only place I speak my mind. Voice my discontent. Speak out if something is a bad call.

KATHRYN

Are you talking about the protests?

ANGELA

Yeah. I'm not doing anything. Not marching. Not speaking out. You had more agency in your plaid skirt than I have as an adult. I'm a chicken shit.

KATHRYN

It's scary right now. The attacks, the rhetoric, the escalation with zero consequences. It's real.

Shakes her head.

ANGELA

Yeah. But *you* go.

KATHRYN

Well yeah, I mean I've marched a few times, but I could do more.

ANGELA

We all could do *more*, but I haven't done anything; I'm too scared. No bumper stickers, because I don't want my car keyed. No t-shirts because I don't want my neighbors to avoid me, no marches or protests because people are getting shot. I haven't

even changed my facebook header. Unless you ask me to my face,
You would have no idea where I stand.

KATHRYN

The danger is real.

ANGELA

But who am I in the face of it?

Grabs her pom pom and yells

Look alive, girls! We're in it to win it!

KATHRYN

It's half time.

ANGELA

Oh.

Looks down

KATHRYN

You could call your senator?

ANGELA

I mean, yeah? But it's California?

KATHRYN

Yeah. Not really moving the needle.

ANGELA

No.

KATHRYN

You could vote with your feet? Don't buy from Amazon, don't go to that restaurant with the Charlie Kirk shrine...

ANGELA

I already don't go there, even though their poke is the bomb.

KATHRYN

Okay...

ANGELA

But, it's a firehose of terrible things every day. And I'm just watching. What will it take to make me stand up and be audacious?

KATHRYN

I know.

ANGELA

What?

KATHRYN

What if you start with one small thing? You know, trot before you run. Everything starts with a trot.

(they look at field)

They're about to kick off. Go Ravens! Go Sashi Kanashi!

ANGELA

Go, Hay Hay Ley Ley!

(they both stand to watch)

(Angela starts trotting in place)

(to herself)

I can trot, I can trot, I used to trot all the time.

(to Kathryn)

What do you think would qualify as a trot?

KATHRYN

(starts trotting)

I don't know. You could deliver food to folks who are afraid to go shopping? I've been tutoring kids who are scared to go to school.

ANGELA

(stops trotting)

Really?

KATHRYN

Yeah. They need a lot of support.

ANGELA

I could do support! And deliveries!

KATHRYN

Great! I'll send you the information.

ANGELA

(Starts jogging again)

I can definitely do that. I don't know when I'll have the time but I can *make* the time, I think, because it matters. Although I can't work *less* right now because everyone's getting laid off and my workload has doubled, and I can't go at night because I need to make dinner and take-out's too expensive, but you know...

KATHRYN

(stops jogging)

What? She tripped her in the penalty box! Where's the call?

ANGELA

(yells)

Yeah! Is your whistle broken?

(whistle is blown)

KATHRYN

(yells)

Yes! Thank you for doing your job!

ANGELA

(pauses and then yells)

Yeah, thank you! And while you're at it, stay out of my vagina!
I'm a grown ass woman who can make my own decisions and it's
none of your business!

KATHRYN

(shrugs)

I mean, sure, we can do this here.

ANGELA

(yelling)

The planet's getting hotter and no one seems to care! Critical
health research is being defunded so we can build a gilded
ballroom!

KATHRYN

It is a soccer game...

ANGELA

I know but I feel *liberated* here. And it just feels so good to
say something.

(yells) The finance bros are pulling the strings of a demented
rapist!

KATHRYN

The audacity is in full effect.

ANGELA.

It is, because I just realized that if Hailey doesn't see me stand up for what's right, how will she know it's not okay to let things go? I'm her example. Plus, I'm probably not gonna get shot here.

KATHRYN

You've got a point.

ANGELA

It's their fault I'm crazy.

KATHRYN

I hear that.

(yells)

You take our rights and freedoms but you pardon insurrectionists and won't take our guns?

ANGELA AND KATHRYN

(Look at each other and high five then look at the field)
We got this!